A-A-20179
October 18, 1991

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SAUCE FOR BROWNING AND SEASONING

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers sauce for browning and seasoning, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

Salient characteristics.

The product shall conform to the following types as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Types.

Type I - Without hydrolized vegetable protein (HVP)
Type II - With HVP

The browning and seasoning sauce shall be prepared from food grade materials and shall be processed using good manufacturing procedures. This ready-to-use sauce may be used to accelerate browning of meats and poultry during cooking, and to enhance the color (browning) and flavor of gravies, sauces, stews, soups, and casseroles. The sauce shall contain carmelized sugar and salt and may contain celery, parsley, carrots, parsnips, turnips, garlic, spices, vinegar, and other ingredients excluding meat or meat extracts.

The manufacturing process, in keeping with good commercial practice, shall preserve the product without impairing the quality and shall preclude microbiological spoilage. The finished product shall be a dark brown-colored liquid free from lumps and free flowing at room temperature. The browning and seasoning sauce shall be a smooth suspension that does not stratify or separate.

Analytical requirements.

Both types of browning and seasoning sauce shall conform to the following analytical requirements:

FSC 8950

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	Type I (without HVP)	Type II (with HVP)
Soluble Solids	Greater than or equal to 52 Brix	Greater than or equal to 52 Brix
Sodium	0.83 to 1.20 percent	0.83 to 1.20 percent
pH	Less than or equal to 3.1	Greater than 3.1
Water Activity	Greater than 0.84	Less than or equal to 0.84

Chemical analyses shall be made in accordance with the following methods in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists:

Test	Chapter and Section	Method
Soluble Solids	Chapter: Sugar and Sugar Products Section: Solids in Syrups	Pycnometer, Spindle, or Refractometer
Sodium	Chapter: Fruits and Fruit Products Section: Sodium in Fruits and Fruit Products	Flame Spectrophoto-metric
pH	Chapter: Vegetable Products, Processed Section: pH of Acidified Foods	pH Meter
Water Activity	Chapter: Vegetable Products, Processed Section: Water Activity of Canned Vegetables	Electrical Conductance

Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics and requirements of this CID; conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories, or possessions; and is sold on the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

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Regulatory requirements.

The delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product in the commercial marketplace. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

Quality assurance.

When the solicitation, contract, or purchase order requires that product quality or acceptability or both be determined, the Processed Products Branch (PPB), Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, shall be the certifying activity and shall make the determination in accordance with applicable PPB procedures. The product shall be examined or analyzed or both in accordance with applicable provisions in the CID, and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The browning and seasoning sauce shall be preserved, packaged, packed, labeled, and case marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

Notes.

Sources of documents:

Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the National Motor Freight Classification may be obtained from:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
2200 Mill Road
Alexandria, VA 22314

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Copies of the Uniform Freight Classification may be obtained from:

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1120
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists may be obtained from:

Association of Official Analytical Chemists
2200 Wilson Boulevard
Suite 400-CD
Arlington, VA 22201-3301

Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1-199. This three-volume set may be purchased from:

Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402-0001

Credit Card (Master Charge or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 783-3238.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from:

Chairperson
Condition of Container Committee
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Room 2506, South Building
P.O. Box 96456
Washington, DC 20090-6456

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from:

General Services Administration
Specifications Unit (3FB-WS)
Room 6654
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

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Comments and suggestions.

Comments and suggestions regarding this CID should be submitted to:

U.S. Army Natick Research,
Development and Engineering Center
ATTN: STRNC-WTP
Natick, MA 01760-5018

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NOTE: The Department of Defense has determined that no military activity has official interest in this Commercial Item Description.

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - FDA, NIH
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

(Project 8950-0329)

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